

DINOSAUR EGGS

In the 1920s, scientists found this amazing 75-million-year-old nest buried deep in the sands of the Gobi Desert in Mongolia. In it were a number of long, narrow eggs arranged in a circle. This was the fossilized nest of an *Oviraptor*, a type of feathered dinosaur. The scientists also found the skeleton of the mother near to the nest, but at first they mistook mother and eggs for two different species. They named the mother *Oviraptor*, meaning “egg thief,” thinking she was a predator trying to steal the eggs. The name stuck, and all dinosaurs in the same family are now called oviraptorosaurs.

